Ishkhan Khchoian

Project Manager — construction, renovation & PropTech

Yerevan, Armenia · remote, or on-site / hybrid in Yerevan · open to relocation
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English (C1) · Russian (native) · Armenian (native)

PROFILE

Project manager with over six years of experience, starting in construction. In a family construction business I managed projects including an investment project made up of 11 public and private tenders worth RUB 42M — interiors, facades, roofing and special-purpose telecom facilities — and every site was delivered on time and accepted with no defects noted. Crews of 2–20, contractors, procurement and logistics between sites: this is where I first built Gantt charts and learned to own an outcome rather than a task list.

I am currently COO of SayWhen.am, an AI voice-agent startup, where I run development with the CTO and manage the company's corporate clients across the full engagement cycle. My legal background in civil contracts and claims means I read the contract and the schedule together. I completed an IT project management course through a U.S. Embassy program and am taking the PSM I exam in November 2026.

WHY ME FOR THIS ROLE

- **I have been on site, not just on the Gantt chart.** Several sites running at once, teams of 2–20. When your users describe a problem with subcontractor scheduling or a snag list, I have lived it rather than read about it.
- **Tenders and procurement.** Prepared and competed in public and private tenders, managed building-supply vendors, materials and transport logistics end to end.
- **Contracts are native to me.** Law degree plus six years of legal practice, including civil-contract analysis and claims. In construction the schedule and the contract are the same argument, and I can read both.
- **Process redesign with measurable results.** At one U.S. company I rebuilt the client-project workflow: the cycle became strictly six months or less, two- and four-month express tracks were introduced, errors decreased, and the share of successful cases rose by 35%.
- **Domain vocabulary for PropTech discovery.** A product for builders, developers or property managers needs someone who can interview them without a glossary. I have been the customer of that software.

SKILLS

- **Delivery:** multi-site scheduling · Gantt charts · contractor and vendor management · procurement and materials · tenders · budget tracking · risk tracking · site coordination · Scrum and Kanban · leading teams of up to 20
- **Commercial & legal:** contract analysis · negotiation · claims and disputes · client communication · documentation and regulations
- **Tools:** Jira · Confluence · Miro · Notion · Trello · Monday · Bitrix24 · amoCRM · Google Workspace · MS Office

EXPERIENCE

COO — SayWhen.am (AI voice-agent startup)

Feb 2026 – present

- Run product development with the CTO in Jira and Confluence: requirements, specification, backlog and priorities, and acceptance of each stage.
- Manage the company's corporate clients across the full engagement cycle: needs discovery, agreement on scope and timelines, and regular progress reporting during implementation.

Freelance — project and legal work

Feb 2026 – present

- Designed a U.S. client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy): a three-scenario funnel model, budget, payback and decision gates.
- Business research for a water production line; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); legal projects — IP assignment for works by popular musicians, a corporate structure for a crypto trader and advice on opening a crypto-exchange office in Armenia; sale of family real estate.

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation (U.S.) Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Owned up to **12 complex client projects at a time**, end to end, against fixed external deadlines.
- Redesigned the delivery process: a cycle of **strictly six months or less**, new **two- and four-month express tracks**, fewer errors through a shared knowledge base, and a **35% higher success rate**.
- Coordinated **8 specialists** and reviewed their work against written acceptance criteria; my templates, checklists and hand-off rules became the team standard.

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp. Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Delivered live events for **100 to 3,000** people — several in parallel, on dates that could not slip; owned vendors, logistics, scheduling and day-of operations.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, scope agreement, timelines and internal follow-through.

Legal practice — U.S. law firms, Arbitration Court, Bar Association Dec 2019 – Aug 2024

- Senior Paralegal at Shamayev Business Law, Paralegal at Bloomrich Law Firm: built the internal training program **Paralegal Academy** (50+ people) and improved the firms' internal processes.
- Judge's Associate: **200+ concurrent cases, 30+ hearings a week**; earlier, contract analysis and claims work at a Bar Association.

Project Manager — SIS LLC (family business) Jun 2015 – Sep 2019

- Managed projects including an **investment project made up of 11 public and private tenders worth RUB 42M** — every site delivered **on time and accepted with no defects noted**.
- Teams of up to 20; procurement, logistics between sites and recruiting; built the first schedules and Gantt charts; set up a regional supply network for the retail business.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

- **Project management** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success" — Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; Jul 21 – Aug 21, 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement.
- **Professional Scrum Master I (Scrum.org)** — exam scheduled for November 2026.
- **Project Management (PM Club)** — 2023, 52 hours.
- **Piscine intensive (C programming)** — 42 Yerevan, Nov–Dec 2025; passed selection and completed it alongside a full-time job.
- **Bachelor of Law, with honors** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.

ALSO

- **2nd place, HackNation** local pitches, final at TUMO Labs (July 2026); **Startup Seaside Summit** — participant.
- **Highload++** (700 attendees) — organizing team, led a crew of 12; performance bonus.
- **Ethos Foundation** — HQ coordinator, Sep 2023 – Oct 2024; aid to ~100 families a day.